

Workplace Conduct and Anti-Harassment Policy

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Classification: Internal — All Employees, Contractors, and Interns

1. Purpose

This policy sets expectations for professional conduct, defines and prohibits harassment and discrimination, and describes how to report concerns and what happens after a report. It applies to all interactions connected to work — in offices, on video calls, at company events, and in work-related communication regardless of platform — and to employees, contractors, interns, and third parties acting on Solarium's behalf.

2. General Standards of Conduct

Solarium expects everyone to:

- Treat colleagues, clients, and partners with professionalism and respect, including in disagreement
- Communicate honestly, including giving and receiving direct feedback without hostility
- Respect confidentiality and data handling obligations described in SOL-SEC-401
- Use good judgment about how humor, casual language, and informal communication land with different audiences — what feels obviously fine to you may not land that way for someone else, especially across a video call or written message where tone is easy to misread
- Comply with applicable law and avoid conduct that creates legal or reputational risk for Solarium

3. Prohibited Conduct

The following are prohibited regardless of intent, seniority, or whether the people involved are also friends outside work:

3.1 Harassment

Unwelcome conduct based on a protected characteristic (race, color, religion, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity or expression, national origin, age, disability, genetic information, veteran status, or any other characteristic protected by applicable law) that is severe or pervasive enough to create a hostile, intimidating, or offensive work environment, or that is made a condition of employment or advancement. This includes:

- Sexual harassment, including unwelcome sexual advances, requests for sexual favors, and other verbal, visual, or physical conduct of a sexual nature
- Offensive jokes, slurs, or comments targeting a protected characteristic
- Unwelcome physical contact or invasion of personal space
- Displaying or sharing offensive images or material, including in chat channels or shared drives

3.2 Discrimination

Treating someone less favorably in hiring, promotion, compensation, assignment, discipline, or termination because of a protected characteristic rather than job-related factors.

3.3 Retaliation

Taking a negative action against someone because they reported a concern in good faith, participated in an investigation, or opposed conduct they reasonably believed violated this policy — even if the underlying complaint is ultimately not substantiated. Retaliation is treated as seriously as the underlying conduct it responds to, and is independently investigated.

3.4 Bullying and Abusive Conduct

Conduct that isn't necessarily tied to a protected characteristic but is nonetheless abusive, threatening, or humiliating — repeated belittling, yelling, public humiliation, sabotaging someone's work, or excluding someone from necessary information as a form of punishment.

3.5 Workplace Violence and Threats

Any act or credible threat of violence, including implied threats, intimidation, or bringing a weapon to a company location or event, except where explicitly authorized (e.g., security personnel). This is a zero-tolerance category — see Section 7.

3.6 Substance Use

Being impaired by alcohol or drugs (beyond moderate, appropriate alcohol consumption at a company-hosted social event) in a way that affects job performance or safety, or using illegal drugs on company property or at company events, is prohibited. Employees with a substance use concern are encouraged to reach out to the EAP (SOL-HR-103) confidentially — seeking help proactively is treated very differently from an incident that triggers a policy response.

4. What This Policy Is Not

Ordinary, respectful workplace disagreement — including disagreeing with a manager's decision, giving critical performance feedback through proper channels, or advocating firmly for a position in a meeting — is not a conduct violation. This policy exists to prevent people from being harassed, discriminated against, or abused, not to flatten normal professional friction or discourage direct feedback given respectfully.

5. How to Report a Concern

You do not have to be the person directly affected to report — reporting something you witnessed is encouraged, not just tolerated.

Reporting Channel	Best For
Your manager	Most situations, if you're comfortable and it doesn't involve your manager
Your manager's manager, or another manager you trust	If your own manager is involved, or you'd rather not go through them
People Operations (people-ops@solarium.example, or in person/video with any HR partner)	Any concern, especially if you want a channel outside your reporting line

Reporting Channel	Best For
Confidential ethics hotline (listed on the internal HR portal, operated by a third party)	If you want to report anonymously, or prefer a channel entirely outside internal management
General Counsel's office	Concerns involving potential legal exposure, senior leadership, or where you want a direct legal-compliance channel

You are never required to report to your own manager if the concern involves them, and using the confidential hotline never affects your standing at Solarium — reports are handled by People Operations and Legal, not routed back to a reported manager to "handle it themselves."

6. What Happens After a Report

- 1 Acknowledgment:** People Operations or the assigned investigator acknowledges receipt within 2 business days and outlines next steps.
- 2 Interim measures:** If needed to protect someone's safety or ability to work (e.g., temporarily adjusting reporting lines or meeting arrangements), interim measures are put in place during the investigation — these are protective, not punitive, and are not an assumption of guilt.
- 3 Investigation:** A trained investigator (from People Operations, Legal, or an external firm for sensitive or senior-level matters) gathers information from relevant parties. Investigations are kept as confidential as possible, shared only with those who need to know to conduct a fair process.
- 4 Outcome:** The reporting party is informed that the investigation concluded and, generally, whether action was taken — specific disciplinary details about another employee are not shared, consistent with standard confidentiality practice, but you will not be left wondering whether anything happened at all.
- 5 Timeline:** Most investigations conclude within 30 days; more complex matters are communicated with a status update if they run longer.

7. Consequences

Consequences scale with the severity and pattern of conduct, and are determined case by case rather than by a fixed formula, but generally range from coaching and a documented warning, through a formal performance improvement plan, to suspension or termination for serious or repeated violations. Threats of violence, retaliation against a reporter, and conduct involving a significant power imbalance (e.g., a manager toward a direct report) are treated with particular seriousness. Contractors and vendors found to have violated this policy may have their engagement terminated.

8. Confidentiality

Reports and investigations are handled with as much confidentiality as is possible while still conducting a fair and thorough process — this usually means information is shared only with people who need it to investigate or to implement interim measures, not broadcast to a team or department. Complete confidentiality (i.e., no one else ever being told anything) usually is not possible if an investigation needs to happen, but discretion is the standing expectation for everyone involved, including witnesses.

9. False Reports vs. Reports That Aren't Substantiated

A report made in good faith that isn't ultimately substantiated is not a false report and carries no consequence for the reporter — investigations often can't reach a definitive conclusion, especially without witnesses, and that's an expected limitation of fact-finding, not evidence the reporter did something wrong. A false report is different: one made with knowledge that it's untrue, intended to harm someone. Deliberately false reports are themselves a conduct violation, but this is assessed separately and should never be assumed just because an investigation was inconclusive.

10. Manager Responsibilities

Managers who become aware of potential conduct violations — whether reported directly to them or simply observed or overheard — are required to report it to People Operations, even if the people involved ask them not to, and even if it seems minor. Managers cannot handle harassment or discrimination concerns informally on their own or agree to keep them "off the record." This requirement exists to make sure patterns get caught, not to remove a manager's ability to have a normal supportive conversation with their team.

Related documents: SOL-SEC-401 (Data Security and Acceptable Use Policy), SOL-HR-104 (New Hire Onboarding Guide), SOL-GOV-000 (Handbook Overview).